User guide

Monash Sport Performance Dashboard

2 November 2026

Contents

1. What the dashboard does 2
2. Quick start 2
3. Before you start 2
    What you need 2
    Where to keep the reports 2
    How to name the files 3
4. Loading your reports 3
    4.1 The first time 3
    4.2 Save your data for next time 4
    4.3 Every time after that 4
    Removing a file 5
5. Finding answers on each page 5
    5.1 Executive Dashboard: prepare a summary for a meeting 5
    5.2 Overview: how is the organisation doing? 6
    5.3 Site Comparison: which sites are doing well? 7
    5.4 Site Detail: visits, memberships and enrolments 8
    5.5 Venues Operations: what is happening at Venues? 8
6. Planning ahead with Forecasting 9
    What the page needs 9
    Worked example: “If casual pay rates rise, how much do prices need to go up?” 9
    Reading the charts 10
    More options 11
    Saving and resetting a plan 11
7. Your monthly routine 11
8. Adding a new year 11
9. When something goes wrong 11
    Messages on the Data page 11
    Common questions 12
    Checking the figures yourself 13
10. Keeping the data private 13
11. Glossary 13

This guide is for Monash Sport staff who want to use the dashboard. You do not need to know anything about coding. If you can open a website, find a folder on your computer and open an Excel file, you can use the dashboard.

Dashboard address: https://vicky-fengz.github.io/ETC5543-Monash-Sports/

The screenshots in this guide use made-up sample data, so the figures in them are not Monash Sport’s real results.

1. What the dashboard does

The dashboard reads the Excel reports Monash Sport already prepares and shows them as charts and summary figures in one place. You can use it to:

- see how Monash Sport is performing this month and this year;
- compare sites, facilities and years side by side;
- look at visits, memberships, enrolments and Venues activity in detail;
- prepare a one-page summary to show in a meeting;
- estimate the next few months' income and expenses, and see how a pay rise or a price change would affect them.

What it does not do. It does not change your Excel files, it does not connect to the finance or booking systems, and it does not replace the monthly reports. You still prepare the reports in Excel as usual; the dashboard only reads them.

Your data stays on your computer. The dashboard runs inside your web browser. When you add your reports, they are read on your own computer and are never sent anywhere else. See section 10.

2. Quick start

If you just want to see the dashboard working, follow these five steps.

1. Open **Google Chrome** or **Microsoft Edge** and go to the dashboard address. Wait about 20 seconds while it loads.
2. Click **Data** in the menu at the top of the page.
3. In the **Add data** box, click **Choose folder** and select the folder that holds the dashboard reports.
4. Wait until every file in the **Uploaded files** list says **READY**. This takes about 3 minutes the first time.
5. Click **Executive Dashboard** at the top of the page to see the summary.

Before you close the page, follow section 4.2 to save your data. Next time, it will load in a few seconds instead of 3 minutes.

3. Before you start

What you need

- A computer with **Google Chrome** or **Microsoft Edge**. Other browsers may work, but these two have been tested.
- Access to the shared folder where the dashboard reports are kept.
- About 5 minutes the first time you load the reports.

You do not need to install anything.

Where to keep the reports

Keep one shared folder for the dashboard reports, for example on the team's OneDrive, SharePoint or Teams site, with access limited to Monash Sport staff. Inside it, use one folder for each type of report:

```
Monash Sport Dashboard Reports/
  Monthly Site Report/
    Monthly Site Report 2025 -December.xlsx
  Business Unit Templates that feed master reports/
    2025/
      Aquatics Site Report 2025.xlsx
      Caulfield Site Report 2025.xlsx
      Health & Fitness Site Report 2025.xlsx
      Participation Program Report 2025.xlsx
      Peninsula Site Report 2025.xlsx
```

```
    Venues Site Report 2025.xlsx
Business Unit Tracking Reports/
  2025 Venues Tracking Report.xlsx
```

How to name the files

The dashboard works out what each file is from its **file name**, so the names matter. Please follow these rules:

Rule	Good example	Problem example
Put **one** year in each file name	`Aquatics Site Report 2025.xlsx`	`Aquatics Site Report 2025 (copy of 2024).xlsx`
Monthly reports start with `Monthly Site Report`	`Monthly Site Report 2026 - March.xlsx`	`March 2026 monthly.xlsx`
Business unit reports say `Site Report` or `Program Report` and start with the unit's name	`Participation Program Report 2026.xlsx`	`PP 2026.xlsx`
Venues reports say `Venues Tracking Report`	`2026 Venues Tracking Report.xlsx`	`Venues 2026.xlsx`
Keep **one** Monthly Site Report and **one** Venues Tracking Report for each year	Replace the year's file with the latest version	Keeping `... -November.xlsx` and `... -December.xlsx` side by side

Keep drafts, old copies and other documents **outside** this folder. If two files cover the same year, the dashboard uses only one of them (see section 9).

Also keep the worksheet names, headings and layout of the reports as they are. The dashboard finds the figures by looking for the usual headings, such as `INCOME`, `EXPENSES` and the month names.

4. Loading your reports

4.1 The first time

1. Open the dashboard and click **Data** in the top menu. Stay on the **Upload & Manage** tab.
2. In the **Add data** box, click **Choose folder** and select the *Monash Sport Dashboard Reports* folder. Folders inside it are included automatically. (You can also click **Choose files** and select individual Excel files.)
3. Your browser may ask whether you want to upload the files to the site. Click **Upload**. This only lets the dashboard read them inside your browser; nothing is sent over the internet.
4. Wait while the files are read. A blue message shows the progress, and the buttons are paused until it finishes. **Keep the page open** during this time. Reading a full set of reports takes about 3 minutes.
5. Read the short summary under the buttons. It says how many files were recognised for each type of report.
6. Look at the **Uploaded files** list. The files are grouped by type of report; click a group's name to open or close it. Each file has a status:

Status	What it means
QUEUED	Waiting to be read
PARSING	Being read now
READY	Read successfully. Its figures are in the dashboard
FAILED	Not used. A message explains why (see section 9)

7. Some **READY** files show a number of warnings. Click **View details** under the file to read them. A warning does not stop the file from being used and does not change any figure; it tells you something in the report that you may want to check, such as a missing month.

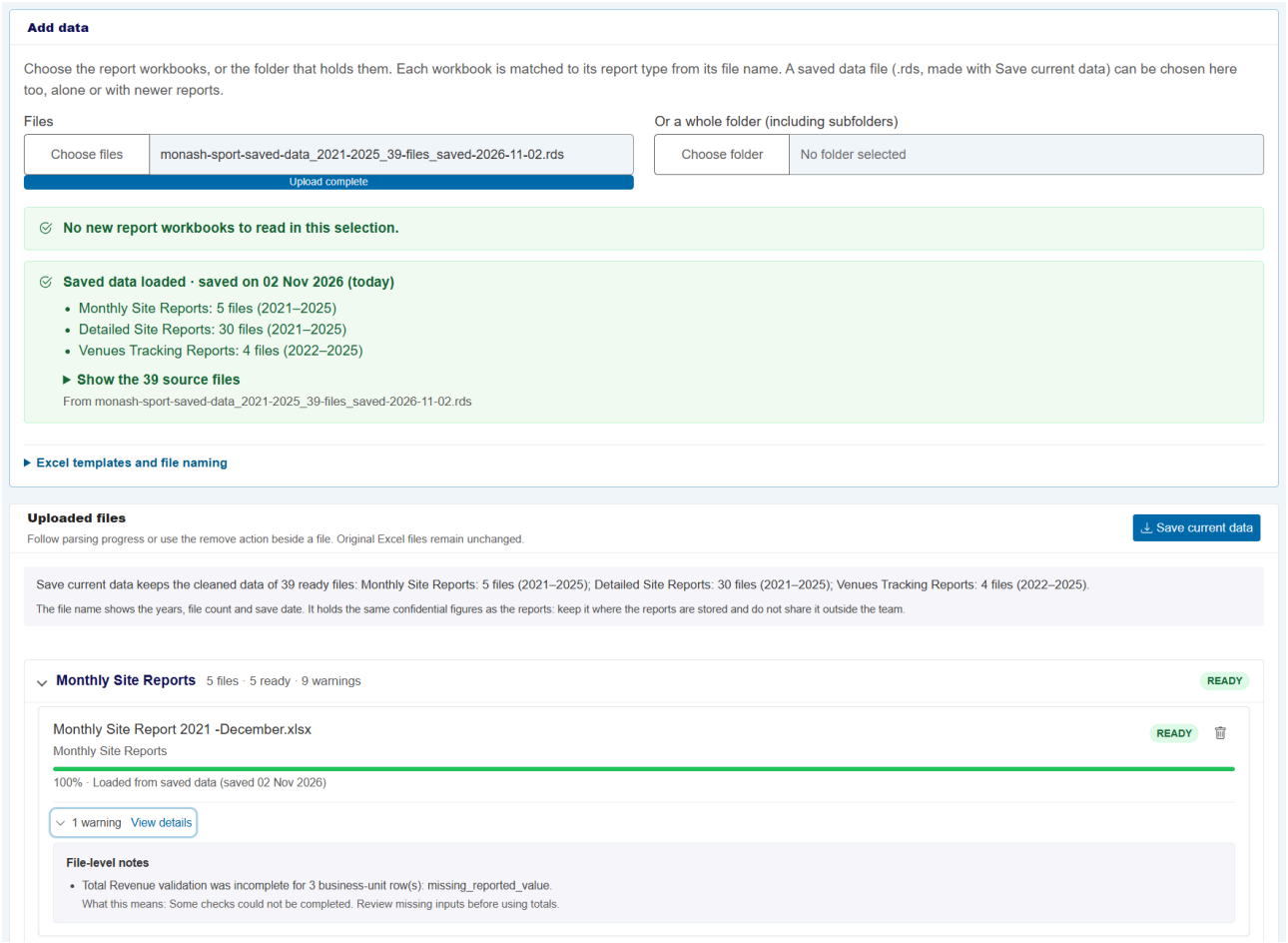


Figure 1: The Data page after loading. The green boxes summarise what was loaded, the **Save current data** button is on the right, and **View details** under a file shows its warnings.

When the files are ready, the top-right corner of the page shows which years are loaded. You can now use any page in the menu.

Close the reports in Excel before you add them. A file that is open in Excel may not be read correctly.

4.2 Save your data for next time

Reading all the reports takes a few minutes. You can save the result so that next time it loads in about 3 seconds.

1. When every file shows **READY**, click **Save current data** at the top of the **Uploaded files** box.
2. Your browser downloads one file with a name like `monash-sport-saved-data_2021-2025_39-files_saved-2026-10-31.rds`. The name tells you which years it covers, how many reports it holds and when it was saved. Please do not rename it.
3. Move the file into the shared *Monash Sport Dashboard Reports* folder, next to the reports.
4. Delete any older saved file in that folder, so there is only one.

The saved file contains the same confidential figures as the reports. Keep it only in the shared report folder. Do not email it or save it anywhere public.

4.3 Every time after that

1. Open the dashboard and click **Data**.
2. Click **Choose folder** and select the *Monash Sport Dashboard Reports* folder again.

3. The dashboard loads the saved file first, which takes a few seconds. It then reads only the reports that are new or have changed since you saved. Reports that have not changed are skipped.
4. If anything new was read, click **Save current data** again and replace the old saved file.

A summary shows when the saved data was made and which reports and years it contains. The summary turns **amber** if the saved data is more than 30 days old, as a reminder to check for newer reports.

Removing a file

To take a file out of the dashboard, click the bin icon next to it in the **Uploaded files** list. This only removes it from the dashboard. Your original Excel file is not changed or deleted.

Closing or refreshing the browser page also clears everything you loaded. That is why saving your data (4.2) is useful.

5. Finding answers on each page

The menu at the top of the dashboard has these pages:

Page	Use it when you want to…	Needs these reports
Executive Dashboard	Show a one-page summary in a meeting	Monthly Site Reports (Detailed Site Reports add facility charts; Venues Tracking Reports are needed for **Metrics**)
Overview	See how the whole organisation is doing over time	Monthly Site Reports
Site Comparison	Compare sites, then look at the facilities in one site	Monthly Site Reports, Detailed Site Reports
Detailed Analysis → Site Detail	See visits, memberships and enrolments for one site	Detailed Site Reports
Detailed Analysis → Venues Operations	See attendance, hire, sales and staffing for Venues	Venues Tracking Reports
Forecasting	Estimate the coming months and test a pay or price change	Monthly Site Reports (Venues Tracking Reports for the pay estimate)
Data	Add, check and remove reports	—

If a page shows a message instead of charts, the reports it needs have not been loaded yet. Go to **Data** and add them.

Tips that work on every page

- Hover your mouse over a chart to see the exact figures.
- Most pages have a period or year selector near the top. Change it and every chart on the page updates.
- All amounts are in Australian dollars (AUD).

5.1 Executive Dashboard: prepare a summary for a meeting

This page puts the most important figures for a meeting on one screen.

1. Choose what to show with the tabs at the top of the page:
   - **Overview** for the organisation's finances as a whole;
   - **Site** to compare sites and look at one site's facilities;
   - **Metrics** for operational figures from the Venues Tracking Reports.

2. In the **Dashboard view** box, under **View**, choose **Year Review** to look at one year, or **Comparison** to compare it with another year. Then pick the **Year** (and the year to **Compare To**).
3. Click **Choose Visuals** to pick the charts you want. In the window that opens, tick the charts you want, or use **Recommended** for a sensible default set, **Select All** or **Clear**. Click **Apply Visuals** when you are done, or **Cancel** to leave things as they were.
4. Click **Presentation View** to show the summary full screen, for example on a projector. Press the **Esc** key on your keyboard to go back.

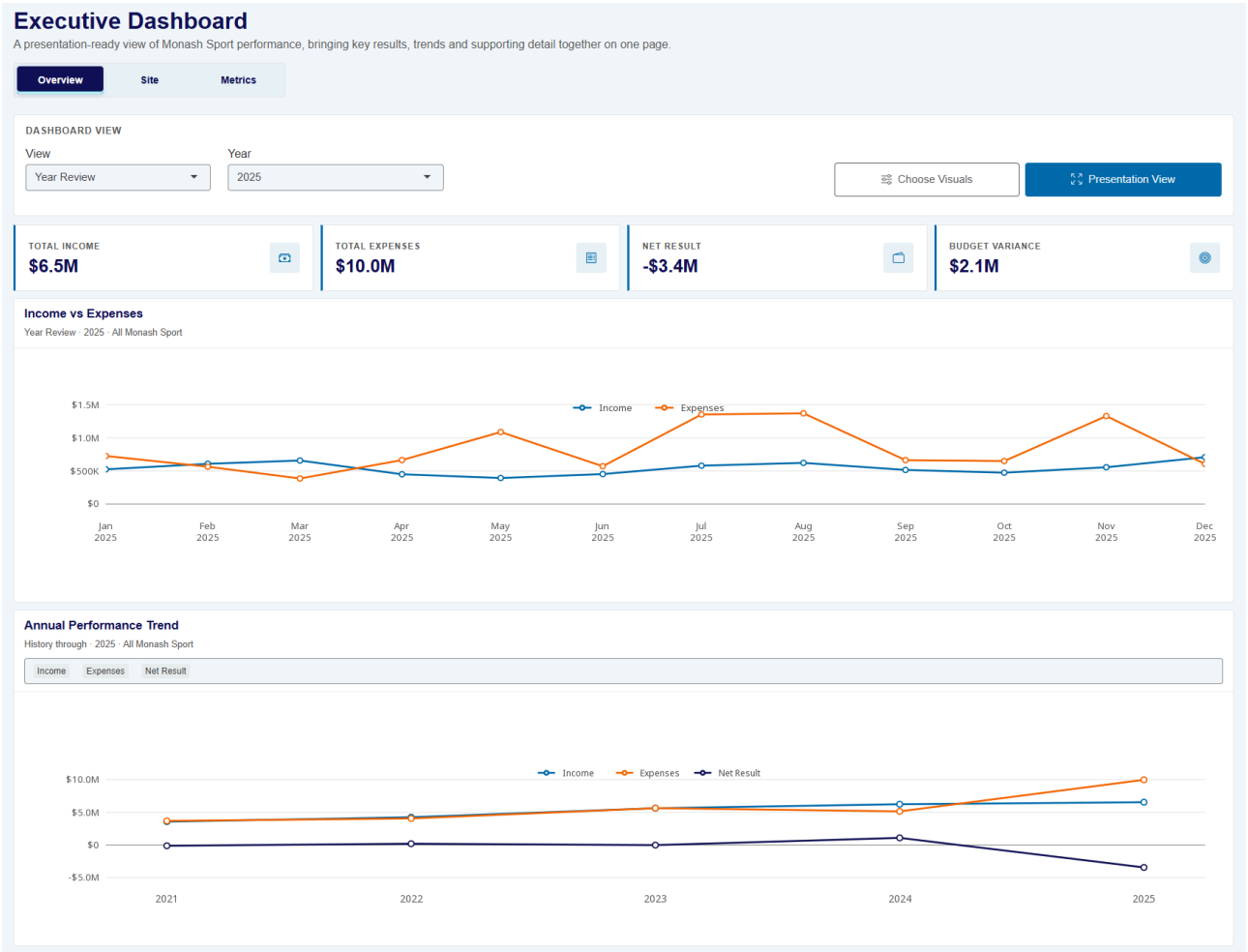


Figure 2: The Executive Dashboard in Year Review. The tabs at the top choose what to show, and the **Choose Visuals** and **Presentation View** buttons are on the right.

Tip: set up the view before the meeting starts, then switch to **Presentation View** when it is your turn to speak.

5.2 Overview: how is the organisation doing?

This page (titled **Overall Performance**) shows the whole of Monash Sport over time.

1. Choose the years to look at with **From Year** and **To Year** under **Analysis period**.
2. Read the **Performance Snapshot**: **Total Income**, **Total Expenses**, **Net Result** and **Budget Variance** for the **latest year** in your chosen period. Under each figure, a short note compares it with the year before or with the budget.
3. Scroll down for the charts:
   - **Income & Expenses Over Time** shows each month;
   - **Annual Performance Trend** shows one figure per year (choose which figure with **Metric**);
   - **Budget vs Actual Net Result Over Time** shows whether results came in above or below budget;
   - **Revenue Opportunity Overview** compares actual income with the income given up through student, staff and other discounts.

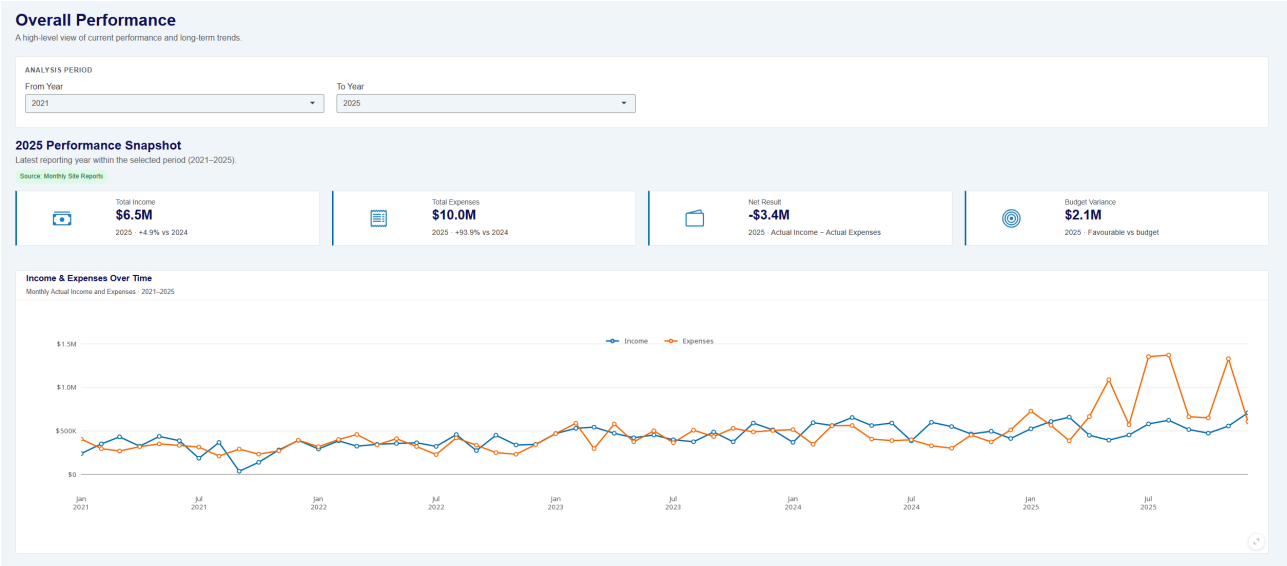


Figure 3: The Overview page, with the Performance Snapshot for the latest year and the monthly Income & Expenses Over Time chart.

5.3 Site Comparison: which sites are doing well?

This page (titled **Site & Facility Comparison**) has two parts.

Comparing sites

1. Choose the years under **Comparison period** and the figure to compare with **Metric** (for example **Income**).
2. **Site Performance Across Years** and **Site Performance Over Time** show each site side by side.
3. **A closer look at the latest year in the selected period** shows the **Site Ranking**, **Budget Performance** and each site's revenue opportunity and discount mix.

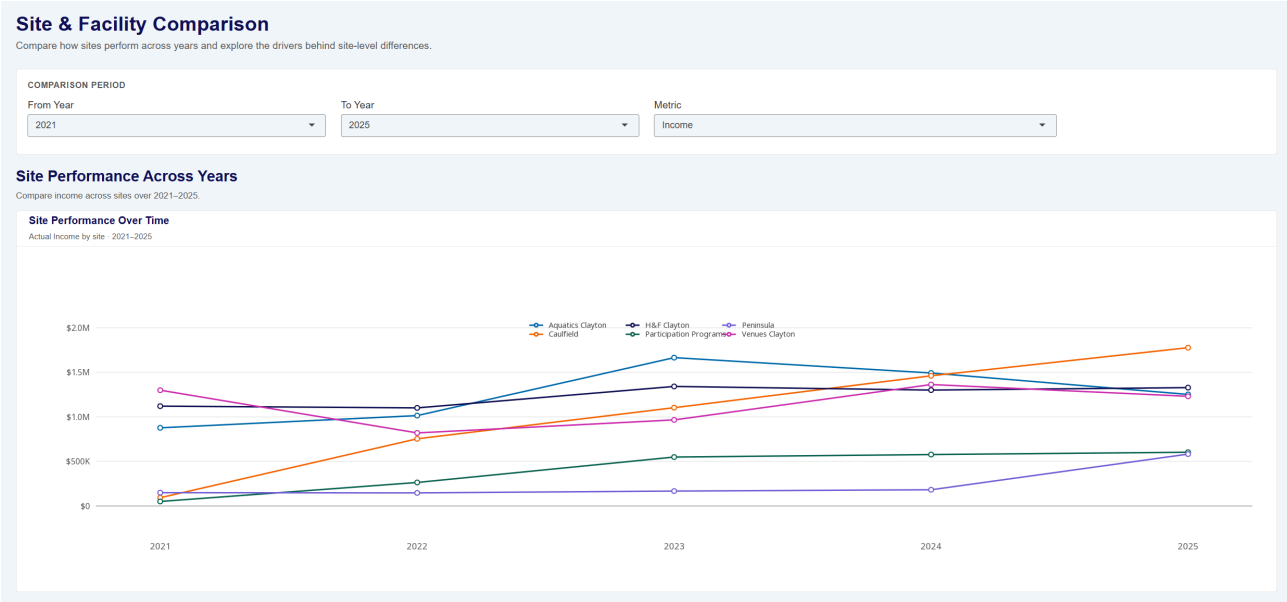


Figure 4: The top of the Site Comparison page. Choose the years and the figure to compare, and each site is shown as its own line.

Looking inside one site

4. Scroll down to **Facility Breakdown**. Under **Facility focus**, choose a **Site** first.
5. Choose a **View**: **Financial Performance**, **Discounts** or **Revenue Opportunity**. The charts below then show the facilities and programs inside that site.

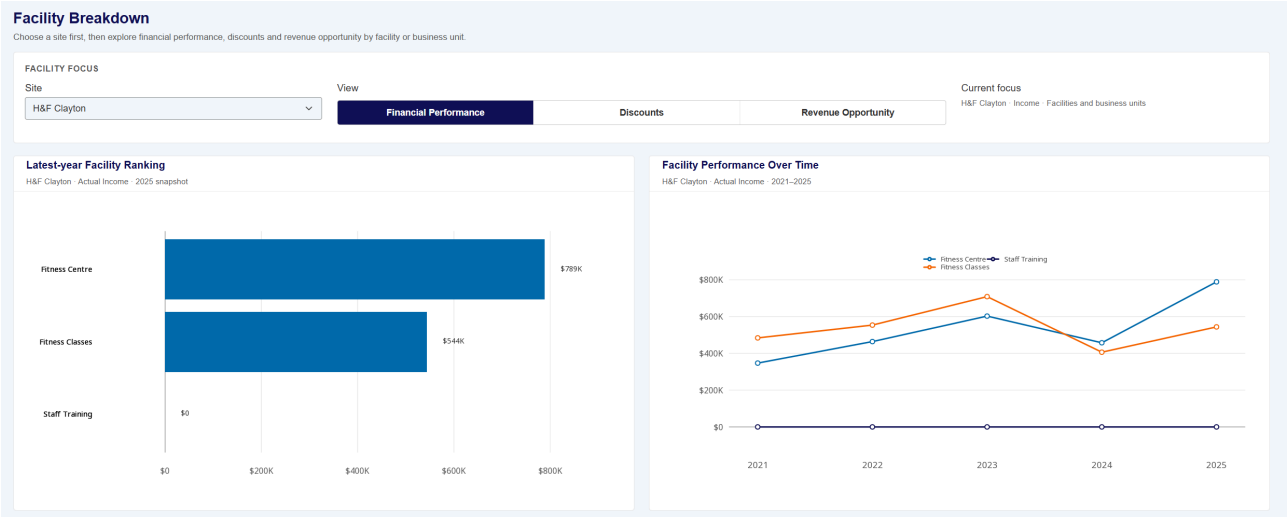


Figure 5: Facility Breakdown, further down the same page. Choose a site and a view to see the facilities and programs inside that site.

5.4 Site Detail: visits, memberships and enrolments

Open **Detailed Analysis** in the top menu and choose **Site Detail**.

1. Choose the **Year** and the **Site**.
2. The line under the selectors (**Available from uploaded reports**) shows which topics the chosen site reports. When there is more than one, choose the one you want to look at:
   - **Visits**: total, direct and indirect visits, and visits by students, staff and community members;
   - **Memberships**: active, new and expired or cancelled memberships;
   - **Enrolments**: active enrolments compared with the target.
3. Read the summary figures at the top, then the month-by-month charts below.

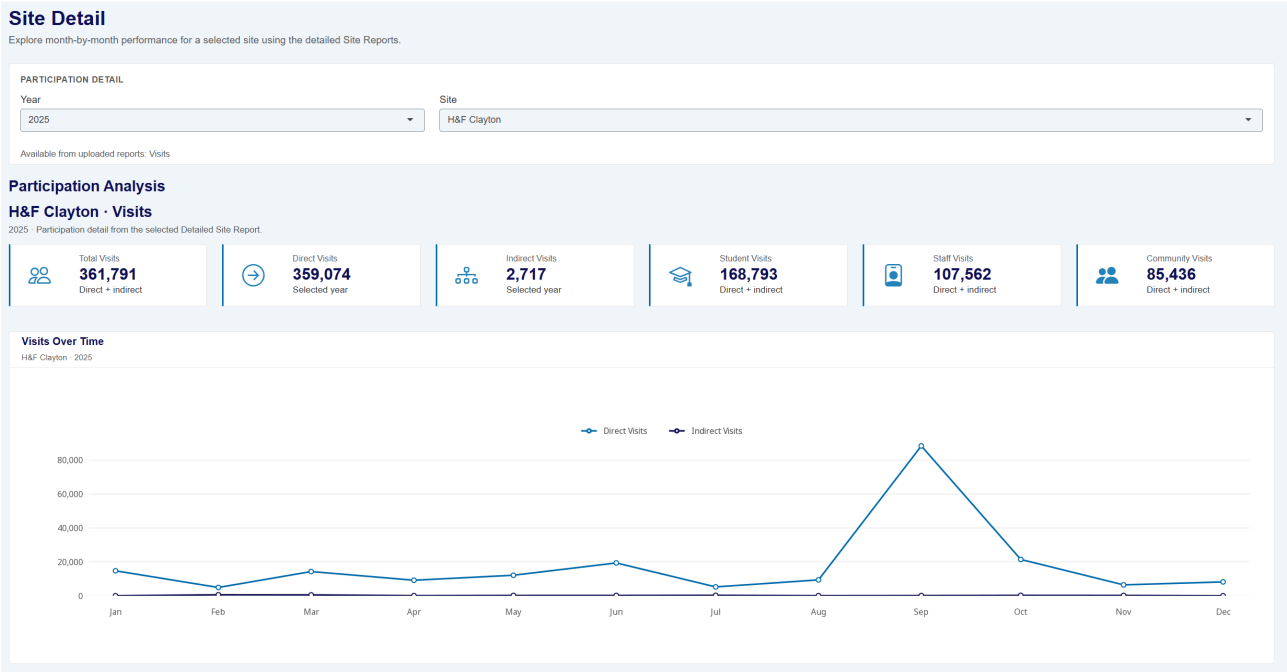


Figure 6: Site Detail for one site, showing visits. The summary figures are at the top and the monthly chart below.

5.5 Venues Operations: what is happening at Venues?

Open **Detailed Analysis** in the top menu and choose **Venues Operations**.

1. Choose the **Year**.

2. Choose an **Operational area**. The list shows only the areas that the chosen year's report contains, and the line under the selectors lists them:
   - **Attendance**: how many people used each facility and activity;
   - **Facility Hire**: hire revenue and number of bookings;
   - **Membership**: Venues membership products and their movements;
   - **Venue Finances**: income and expenses for Venues;
   - **Online Sales** and **Merchandise**: sales by product;
   - **Workforce**: casual staff hours and wages.
3. Read the summary figures, then the month-by-month charts.

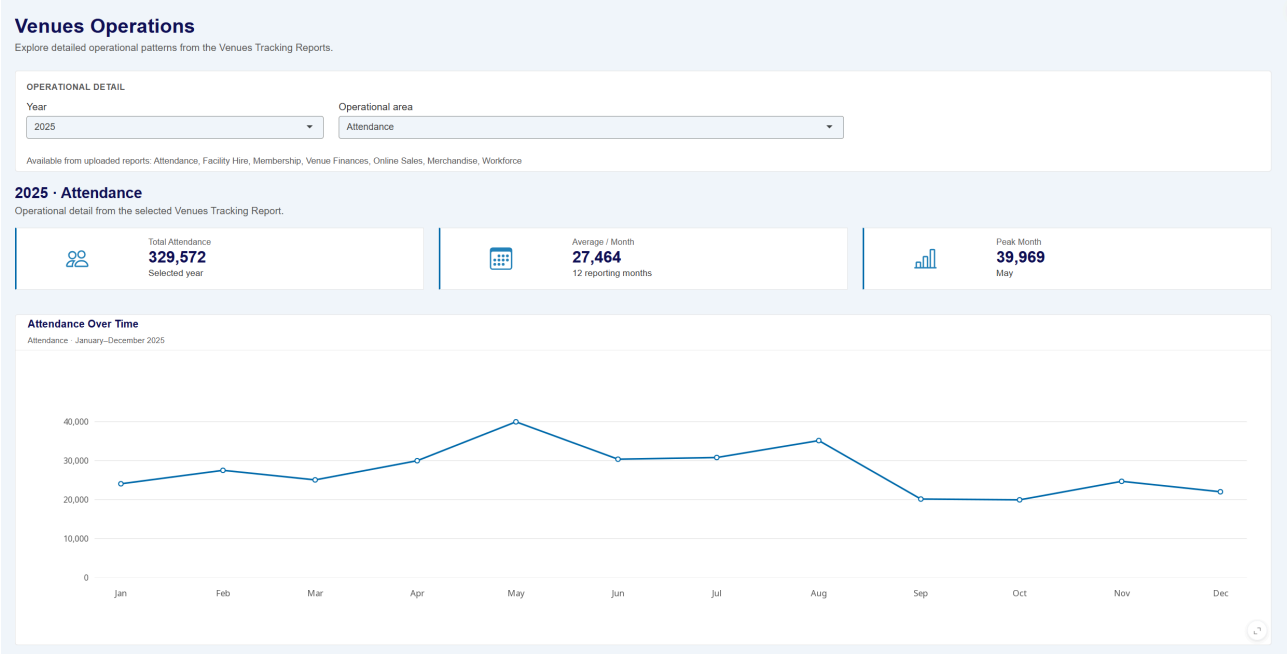


Figure 7: Venues Operations with Attendance selected: the total for the year, the monthly average, the busiest month and a month-by-month chart.

6. Planning ahead with Forecasting

The **Forecasting** page estimates Monash Sport's total income and expenses for the next few months, based on past results. You can then test changes, such as a pay rise for casual staff or a price increase, and see what they would mean.

Please remember: the forecast is an estimate based on what happened in the past, not a guarantee. It does not know about events that have not happened before. Use it to explore options and support a discussion, not as a fixed budget.

What the page needs

At least **12 months in a row** of Monthly Site Reports, with both income and expenses filled in. With fewer, the page explains what is missing. Two or more years of reports give better results. To estimate the cost of a casual pay rise, the Venues Tracking Reports are also needed.

Worked example: "If casual pay rates rise, how much do prices need to go up?"

1. Load the Monthly Site Reports and Venues Tracking Reports (section 4) and click **Forecasting** in the top menu.
2. Under **Your plan**, choose a **Forecast horizon** of 12 months.
3. Enter the expected rise in **Casual pay increase (%)**, for example `5`.
4. Leave **Price increase (%)** at `0` for now.
5. Look at **Your results**:

- **Scenario Income** and **Scenario Expenses** show the totals for the plan, with the original forecast (**Baseline**) underneath;
- **Minimum Price Increase** shows how much prices would need to rise for income to cover expenses over the whole plan.

6. Scroll down to **Income needed to cover costs** and click **Use this minimum price**. The price increase is copied into your plan, and the charts update.
7. Check the **Price sensitivity** chart. The solid line shows income at different price increases, and the dashed line shows expenses. Where they cross is the price increase that covers costs.

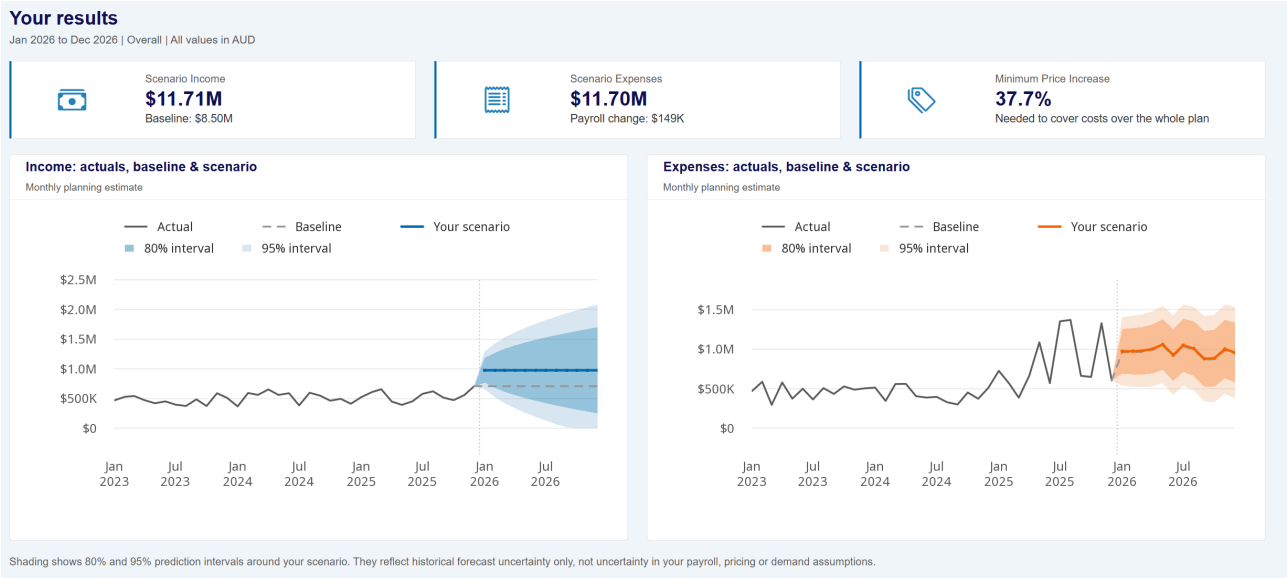


Figure 8: Your results for a 12-month plan: the three summary cards, and the Income and Expenses charts with the forecast ranges shaded.

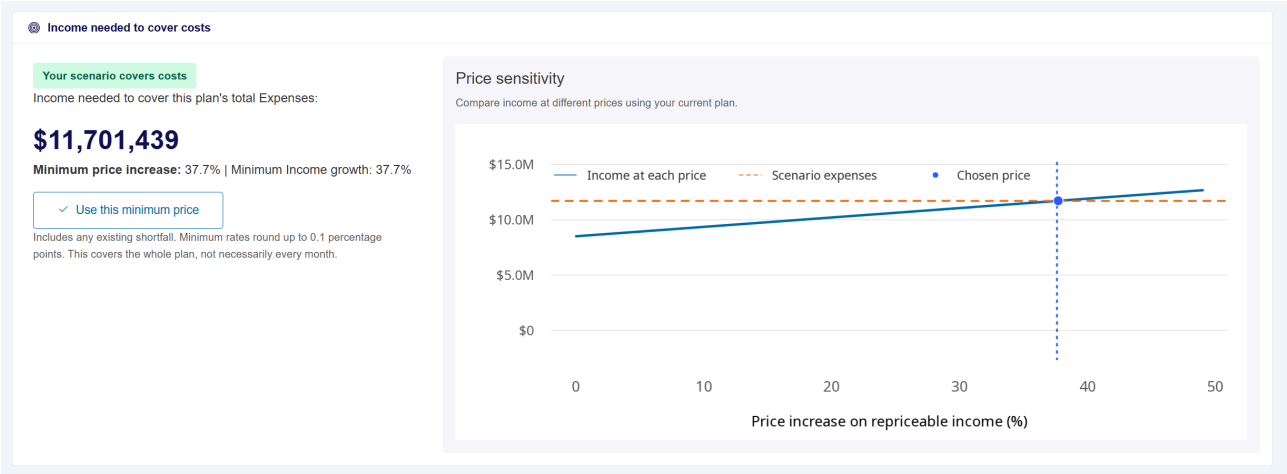


Figure 9: Income needed to cover costs, with the **Use this minimum price** button and the Price sensitivity chart.

Reading the minimum price increase. The minimum also covers any gap that already exists between income and expenses, not just the pay rise. It applies to the plan as a whole, so some individual months may still show income below expenses.

Reading the charts

The **Income** and **Expenses** charts show:

- **Actual**: past results from your reports (dark line);
- **Baseline**: the forecast before any of your changes (dashed line);
- **Your scenario**: the forecast after your changes (coloured line);

- **80% interval** and **95% interval**: the shaded areas show the range the results are likely to fall in. The further ahead you look, the wider they get, because the future is less certain. These ranges do not include uncertainty about your own assumptions, such as how customers react to a price rise.

More options

Click **More options** to change less common settings:

- **Payroll**: choose **Quick estimate** (a percentage rise in casual pay, based on past Venues casual wages) or **Manual adjustment** (type in how much monthly costs will change, for example `2000` for new hires costing $2,000 a month more, or `-4000` for $4,000 a month of savings). Only one method is used at a time.
- **History**: choose which years of past results to use (**Use history from**) and the last month to treat as actual (**Last actual month**).
- **Pricing and timing**:
  - **Income that can be repriced (%)**: lower this if some income has fixed prices that will not change;
  - **Demand / volume change (%)**: your own assumption about how much demand will change, for example `-5` if you expect 5% fewer customers after a price rise. The dashboard does not work this out for you;
  - **Changes take effect from**: the month the changes start.

If the latest months in your reports are all zeros, the page asks whether those months are real results or simply **not yet reported**. Choose **Not yet reported** unless you know the zeros are real.

Saving and resetting a plan

- **Download plan (CSV)** saves the month-by-month figures, which you can open in Excel.
- **Download assumptions (CSV)** saves the settings you used, so you can explain the plan later.
- **Reset plan** puts every setting back to its starting value.

7. Your monthly routine

When a new month's reports are ready:

- ☐ Save the updated reports in the shared folder, **replacing** the previous version of the same year's file (do not keep both).
- ☐ Close the reports in Excel.
- ☐ Open the dashboard, click **Data** and choose the shared folder.
- ☐ Wait until the new files show **READY**. Click **View details** on any file with warnings and check them.
- ☐ Click **Save current data** and replace the old saved file in the shared folder.
- ☐ Before the meeting, open **Executive Dashboard**, set up the view and use **Presentation View**.

8. Adding a new year

1. Put the new year's reports in the same folders as before, following the naming rules in section 3.
2. Add them to the dashboard in the usual way. The earlier years stay loaded.
3. Save your data again.

If you need to start a report from scratch, blank Excel templates are available on the **Data** page: open **Excel templates and file naming** in the **Add data** box and click the template you need to download it. Each template has a guide sheet that explains which cells to fill in. Please keep the template's worksheet names and headings as they are, so the dashboard can read it.

If a report is redesigned substantially (for example, its main headings or worksheets are renamed), the dashboard may not be able to read it. In that case, contact the person who looks after the dashboard (see the maintainer guide).

9. When something goes wrong

Messages on the Data page

What you see	What it means	What to do
A file shows **FAILED** with *"Not used: the … are already loaded from …"*	Another file for the same year is already loaded. Using both would count the same figures twice	Keep one file per year. Remove the one you do not want, then add the other again, or give the new file the same name as the old one so it replaces it
"The file name says 2026, but the workbook holds 2025 figures"	The year in the file name is wrong	Rename the file with the correct year and add it again
"This workbook has no figures yet; it looks like a blank template"	The file has no figures filled in	Add it once at least one month has been filled in
A file is listed with a **Choose report type** box	The file name does not match any report type	Choose the right type and click **Add**, or click **Dismiss**. Renaming the file to follow the rules in section 3 also works
"… already loaded with the same name and size …"	The file has not changed since it was loaded	Nothing. The dashboard skips it to save time
A **READY** file with warnings	Something in the report may need checking, such as a missing month or a total that does not match its parts. The figures are still used as reported	Click **View details**, read the warnings, and check the original Excel file
"This saved file is incomplete or damaged, so nothing was loaded"	The saved data file cannot be read	Add the original Excel reports instead, then save a new copy
"This file was saved … by an older version of the dashboard"	The dashboard has been updated since the file was saved	Add the original Excel reports again, then save a new copy
A red message: **The upload did not finish**	The files did not reach the dashboard	Wait until any reading has finished, then choose the files again

Common questions

The page is blank or keeps loading. Wait about 20 seconds the first time. If nothing appears, refresh the page. Check that you are using Chrome or Edge.

A page says there is no data. The reports that page needs have not been loaded. Check the table at the start of section 5 and add them on the **Data** page.

A figure looks different from my Excel report. Check that the latest version of the report was loaded (look at the file name in **Uploaded files**) and that the same years are selected on the page. Then open **View Cleaned Data** on the Data page: it shows every figure the dashboard read, with the worksheet and cell it came from, so you can compare it with the Excel file directly.

Everything disappeared. Closing or refreshing the page clears the loaded reports. Load your saved data file again (section 4.3).

Forecasting shows a message instead of a forecast. The page needs at least 12 months in a row of Monthly Site Reports with both income and expenses. Read the message: it says which months are missing or need checking.

Checking the figures yourself

On the **Data** page, the **View Cleaned Data** tab lists every figure the dashboard read from your reports. You can filter and search it, and download it as an Excel file. Each figure shows the file, worksheet and cell it came from.

10. Keeping the data private

- The dashboard website contains only the dashboard itself, never your reports.
- When you add reports, they are read **inside your browser on your own computer**. They are never sent to a server.
- Closing or refreshing the page removes them from the dashboard.
- Your original Excel files are never changed.
- The saved data file (`.rds`) contains the same confidential figures as the reports. Keep it only in the restricted shared folder. Do not email it or share it outside the team.

11. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Actual	The amount that was really earned or spent
Budget	The amount planned for the year
Net Result	Income minus expenses
Budget Variance	Actual net result minus budgeted net result. A positive number means the result was better than budget
YTD (year to date)	The total from the start of the year up to the latest month
Discount opportunity	Income given up through student, staff and other discounts
Potential Revenue	Actual income plus the discount opportunity: what income would have been without discounts
Revenue Capture Rate	Actual income as a share of potential revenue
Direct visits / indirect visits	Visit types as recorded in the Detailed Site Reports
Baseline	The forecast before any of your changes
Scenario	The forecast after your pay, price and demand changes
Prediction interval	The shaded range around a forecast where results are likely to fall (80% or 95% of the time)
Repriceable income	The part of income whose price you can change
Saved data file	The `.rds` file made by **Save current data**, which reloads your data in seconds
Warning	A note about something in a report that may need checking. The file is still used
Failed	The file was not used. The message explains why